Megan LaRussa

STYLE YOURSELF CHIC

Body Type Guide

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How To Use This Guide

Bonjour Femme!

The trick to looking your best in everything that you wear is learning what type of clothing will balance your body and what parts of your body you should conceal and reveal. It's important to note that not every item in every store and not every trend will work on your body type so it's time to learn which ones are best for you!

It's easy to look at magazines, celebrities, that best dressed woman you know and feel like you'll never be able to look that good or that you need to lose weight, etc. But in reality you can look that good in your own way by knowing those ladies secret tricks. If someone looks great it's because they know how to dress their silhouette, and it's time you know yours.

The two factors for looking your best: dress to balance you body and learn to conceal your flaws and reveal your assets. As humans we are naturally drawn to balance. Nature is naturally balanced, not perfect just like humans, but it is symmetrical. Balance in the way you dress allows for a naturally attractive look. Since humans aren't naturally balanced because perfection doesn't exist you need to learn your shape so that you can create the illusion of balance, no matter what your silhouette.

How To Use This Guide

Often times when working with a client they are determined that they have for example big hips and they must be a 'pear'. Well first of all women aren't fruit, they are feminine shapes. Second, 99.9% of the time those clients that think they have big hips actually are an hourglass and have natural balance, they just aren't dressing accordingly.

When deciphering your body type it's also vital to wear the right undergarments. If you are wearing the right bra you'll accentuate a small waist (even if you think you don't have one). If you're wearing the right panties then you'll have zero panty lines and unnecessary bulges. So do add well-fitting undergarments to your shopping list to ensure you look as flattering as possible.

Now it's time to take your real measurements, and from there learn all about your fabulous body type!

Yours in Style,

Megan

How to Take Your Measurements

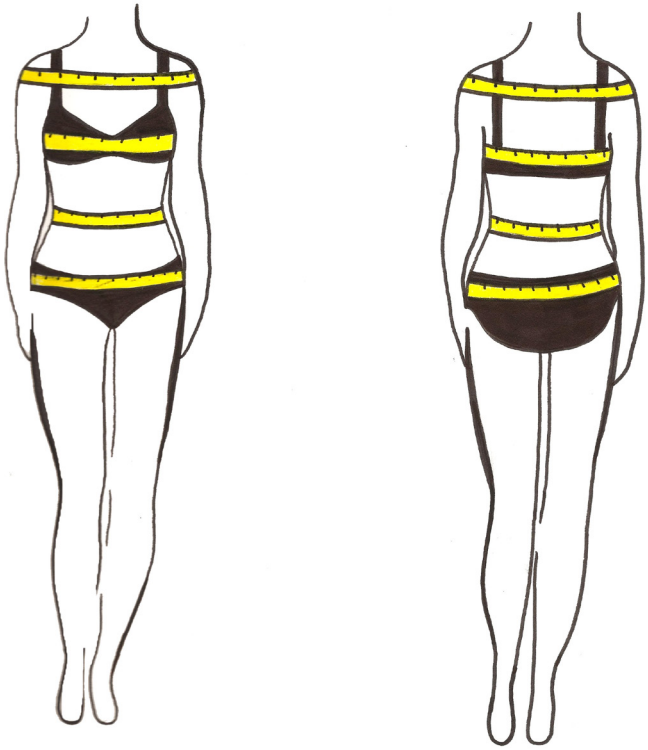
Expert Tip: It's best to have someone else take your measurements to ensure they are accurate.

My Shoulders are _____ inches.
Expert Tip: Measure your shoulders fully around your body at the widest point on your shoulders.

My Bust is _____ inches.
Expert Tip: Wrap the measuring tape fully around your body at the middle of your bust. Pull the tape tight without squishing your bust.

My Waist is _____ inches.
Expert Tip: The measuring tape should go fully around your body at the smallest place on your waist, typically right above the belly button.

My Hips are _____ inches.
Expert Tip: Wrap the tape around the widest point of your hips and butt. It should go fully and evenly around your body.



Hourglass

You are an Hourglass if..
..your shoulders and hips are around the same size and your waist is defined (think 8-10" smaller than your shoulder and hip measurements). Your main style goal is to keep the natural balance of your hips and shoulders while defining your smaller waist.

Tops: V and scoop necklines are best as they prevent you from looking top heavy. Select well-draped fabrics that showcase your smaller waist without clinging to areas you don't love. Button downs with princess seams look nice on you, just keep the top 2 buttons undone to provide a v-neck.

Pants: You can really do most pant styles, just avoid any that add bulk to your bottom half which throws off the natural balance of your body. Skinny jeans, boot cut jeans, trouser pants, straight leg, and ankle pants all are your friend. Remember to avoid any front pleats or boxy fabrics.

Skirts: Pencil skirts in a nice fabric are best on you. When wearing a pencil skirt make sure to tuck in your top or wear a shorter tailored top to accentuate your natural shape. A slight a-line skirt can be nice as well, just balance the flare with a top that adds interest with a boat neck or fun sleeve.

Dresses: Sheath dresses, wrap dresses and fit-and-flare dresses are the best silhouettes for you. Keep the neckline below the collarbone, and always accentuate your smaller waist and you'll be sure to look your best.

Inverted Triangle

You are an Inverted triangle if..
..your shoulders and/or bust is larger than your hips. Your main style goal is to diminish your shoulders while adding interest to your bottom half to create balance overall.

Tops: Draw attention away from your broader shoulders with v-neck tops. Focus on styles WITHOUT horizontal stripes, puffed shoulders, bell sleeves, and epaulet details.

Pants: Boot cut style pants and jeans are typically best as they balance out your broader shoulders. Select the modern version of boot cut that is more tailored in the thigh and then flares at the knee. Instead of skinny jeans or leggings opt for a slim straight or straight leg for a more flattering look.

Skirts: Just like pants, skirts should balance out your shoulders, thus accentuating a smaller waist. A-line style skirts are best, but remember to keep your shirt more tailored to avoid having too much fabric overall.

Dresses: Avoid spaghetti straps, boat necks or strapless styles that only broaden your shoulders. Instead select thicker strap dresses in styles like a drop waist, fit-and-flare, and a-line.

Triangle

You are a Triangle if..
..your hips are wider than your shoulders. Your main style goal is to diminish your hips and add interest to your top half to create balance overall.

Tops: Fun tops are your best friend! Opt for boat necks, bell sleeves, puffed shoulders, and even striped tops. Silk blouses with breast pockets are great if you have a smaller chest.

Pants: Darker hued pants and jeans are best for you. Stick to styles that balance out your hips, such as the modern boot cut and straight leg to ensure you don't widen your bottom half.

Skirts: Select skirts in materials that drape beautifully and don't add bulk. Avoid any stiff or thick fabrics, and avoid pockets altogether. Sleek a-line styles skim over your hips for a flattering look.

Dresses: Boat neck dresses with a-line skirts are the perfect dress option for you. Make sure to have some shape and definition at your natural waist too for a flattering shape.

Rectangle

You are a Rectangle if..
..your shoulders, bust, waist and hips are all around the same measurement. Your style goal is to add interest at your shoulders and hips, thus making your waist look smaller in comparison.

Tops: Boat necks, wide scoop and v-neck style tops are most flattering to draw the eye out, thus making your waist look smaller in comparison. Stick with well-draped fabrics and cuts, like a peplum, that don't add boxy-ness to your more rectangular silhouette. And nothing double breasted, ever.

Pants: To draw the eye out, thus making the waist smaller in comparison, try out boot cut jeans and pants. Avoid leggings or anything that will showcase a more rectangular shape.

Skirts: Select skirts in materials that drape beautifully and don't add bulk. Avoid any stiff or thick fabrics, and avoid pockets altogether. Sleek a-line styles skim over your hips for a flattering look.

Dresses: Boat neck dresses with a-line skirts are the perfect dress option for you. Make sure to have some shape and definition at your natural waist too for a flattering shape.

Petite & Plus Size 101

Petite Style Tips:
1. Dark knee high boots cut your petite figure in half, making you look shorter.
2. Select prints that are in proportion to your size, so if you're more petite then a smaller print is best.
3. While monochromatic is always nice and elongating, tonal can often be more interesting. Tonal means wearing varying shades of the same color/neutral in your outfit. Incorporate different textures into your outfit as well to create interest.
4. Avoid shoes with chunky soles, such as thick wedges, as they will simply add bulk to your body and prevent elongation of your silhouette.
5. Keep your hemline at flattering places at your leg. Skip anything that's too long, like a maxi skirt or dress, and anything too short, like a capri pant.

Plus Size Style Tips:
1. Quality fabrics are your best friend.
2. Stop trying to cover up with boxy tops, long straight jackets, and shift dresses. You are actually making yourself look heavy. Your clothes should trace your natural silhouette without being clingy.
3. Focus on bolder, larger accessories that are more proportionate with your silhouette. Anything too small will make you look larger in comparison. This is especially true if you are a taller woman.
4. Proper fitting undergarments are vital to help you look and feel your best. A great fitting bra needs to be an essential that you invest in every year. Also, make sure to have seamless smoothing shapers to wear under dresses, skirts and even pants.
5. Avoid garments with too much going on, such as ruffles, tiers, etc. These extra details will simply add bulk to you and do not help you look your best.

10 Universal Style Rules

1. V or scoop necklines are always more flattering than high necklines.

2. Shiny fabrics should never be worn on areas you want to conceal. They draw attention and can add bulk.

3. Stiff fabrics will always add bulk to an area, so select your fabrics carefully. When in doubt always go for well draped items.

4. Oval or almond toe shaped shoes will elongate and make any silhouette look more flattering.

5. Princess seams (look them up if you don't know what they are!) are everyone's best friend as they accentuate or create the illusion of a natural waist.

6. Don't expect items to always fit perfectly right off the rack. Find a seamstress or tailor that can help you hem items, take up items in the shoulders, nip in the waist, etc.

10 Universal Style Rules

7. Ignore the size in the garment as every store & brand has different fit models and often times vanity sizing. That's why it's vital to always try on an item before purchasing and leaving the store. Or if you're ordering online, order two sizes to determine the right fit.

8. The size of the print on your garment should always be proportionate to your size and height. If you are a curvier, taller woman then a larger print is more flattering. If you are a petite woman, a smaller print is more flattering.

9. Hemlines should always hit at a flattering place on your leg, like the top of your knee cap or your ankle. You would never want a hemline to hit at a wider place on your leg, like your calf muscle.

10. Skinny jeans may be a classic item, but they are not flattering on everyone (refer to your body type to see if they work for you). But the right boot cut jean is flattering on every silhouette, so invest in a quality dark wash pair.